

Food & Grocery Help

If your income doesn't cover groceries every month, you're not alone — and real help exists. Federal benefits and community food programs can put food on your table this week and every month. Tick the box once you've contacted each one.

⚠ BEFORE YOU START

Many people who qualify never apply because they don't know these programs exist. There's no risk in checking your eligibility, and applying is always free. Your local food bank can even help you fill out the forms.

1 Monthly Grocery Benefits (SNAP)

SNAP (formerly food stamps) loads money onto a card you use like debit at grocery stores and many farmers markets. It's the biggest food program in the country.

☐ SNAP — How to Apply

Apply through your state. Income limit is generally around 130% of the federal poverty level, with higher limits for households with seniors or disabled members.

→ www.fns.usda.gov/snap/recipient/eligibility

☐ Find Your State SNAP Office

Each state runs its own application. This finds your state's office and online application.

→ www.fns.usda.gov/snap/state-directory

2 Food Right Now (Food Banks & Pantries)

Food banks give out free groceries — shelf-stable items, fresh produce, dairy, sometimes meat. Most serve anyone in their community who asks.

☐ Feeding America — Find Your Food Bank

A network of 200+ food banks and 60,000 pantries and meal programs. Enter your ZIP to find free food near you.

→ www.feedingamerica.org/find-your-local-foodbank

☐ 211 — Local Food Help

Call or search to find pantries, hot meals, and food programs in your area.

→ www.211.org or dial 211

3 For Pregnant Women, Babies & Young Kids (WIC)

WIC provides healthy foods, formula, nutrition help, and breastfeeding support for families with young children.

☐ WIC — Women, Infants & Children

Free healthy groceries and support if you're pregnant, recently had a baby, or have a child under 5, and meet income rules (or get SNAP, Medicaid, or TANF).

→ www.fns.usda.gov/wic

4 Help for Kids & Seniors

Targeted programs feed children during the school year and summer, and provide groceries for older adults.

☐ Free & Reduced-Price School Meals

Your child may qualify for free or low-cost meals at school and food over the summer. Ask your child's school or district office.

→ **Ask your child's school**

☐ Senior Food Programs

Food help for adults 60+, including the Commodity Supplemental Food Program. Find options through the Eldercare Locator.

→ eldercare.acl.gov or call 1-800-677-1110

☐ FDIIR — Food Distribution on Indian Reservations

Monthly packages of healthy food for eligible households on or near reservations.

→ www.fns.usda.gov/fdiir

⚠ WATCH OUT FOR

Be careful of sites that charge a fee to "apply for SNAP" or sell an EBT card. Applying for SNAP, WIC, and food bank help is always free through official .gov sites and nonprofits.

★ A TIP THAT HELPS

Food banks serve everyone — you don't need to be on benefits to use them, and you can use them while your SNAP application is being processed. Don't wait until the cupboard is empty.

NEED HELP WHERE YOU LIVE?

Ask for your personalized food search

This guide covers the main national programs. For pantries, hot meals, and food help specific to your city or ZIP code, use the personalized AI search or ask in the Questions area, and we'll help you find the closest options.

MY NOTES — WHO I CALLED, WHEN, AND WHAT THEY SAID
